

BAYRENTALS

Project Phantom

The rental platform we're building

One system for customers, staff, and the owner — across app, web, and Turo.

What we're building

One system that runs the whole rental business. Customers book and sign from their phone, staff run pickups and returns from theirs, and you see and control everything from a laptop. Bookings from the app, from Bayrentals.com, and from Turo all land on the same calendar, so a car can never be promised to two people at once.

Today the pieces of that live in different places — a paper agreement at the counter, photos in someone's camera roll, Turo dates in a separate app, availability in someone's head. Phantom puts all of it in one place, and makes the parts that are error-prone impossible to get wrong.

Four things get built

iPhone app	One app, two faces. Customers browse the fleet, book, pay, and sign. Staff sign in and get the counter tools — today's schedule, the calendar, guided pickup and return, photos, contracts.
Owner console	A web dashboard for your laptop. Every number about the business, and the ability to edit anything in it — bookings, cars, pricing, customers, contracts, refunds.
Booking backend	The shared brain: the fleet, the calendar, customers, pricing, photos, signed contracts, and payments. Everything else is a window onto it.
Website booking	Bayrentals.com gets a real booking flow showing the same cars, the same availability, and the same prices as the app — no separate list to keep in sync.

What the customer gets

The goal is that renting from you feels easier than renting from Hertz — and that by the time someone arrives to pick up a car, everything is already done.

Booking

- Browse the fleet with real photos, see live availability, pick dates and extras (child seat, toll pass, delivery, prepaid fuel).
- See the full price broken out before committing — nightly rate, discounts, extras, fees, taxes, deposit. No surprises at the counter, ever.
- Pay with Apple Pay in one tap. No password to create — sign in with Apple or a code sent to their email; first-timers can book as a guest.
- The car is theirs the moment they pay, and those dates disappear from everyone else's screen instantly.

Before pickup

Their trip becomes a checklist they finish from their couch instead of at your counter:

- **License:** they photograph the back of their license and the app reads the barcode — name, birthdate, number, and expiry fill themselves in. Nothing to type.
- **Contract:** they read the rental agreement and sign it with a finger. A signed PDF is emailed to them and kept in the app.
- **Reminders:** the app says what's still missing, then reminds them the day before with directions. The booking can go in Apple Wallet.

The pickup itself

A customer who did all that walks up, hands over nothing, watches a two-minute walkaround, and drives away. That is the whole point of the design.

During and after

- A reminder before the car is due back, so late fees surprise nobody.
- A receipt on return, with any extra charges itemized and explained, and the deposit released.
- Past trips, receipts, and contracts stay in the app — rebooking the same car takes two taps.

What your staff gets

The rule we designed to: someone new should be able to do a pickup correctly on their first day with nobody standing over them. The app leads, they follow.

The day at a glance

Opening the app shows today — who is picking up, who is returning, anything overdue in red, any Turo booking that needs a human look, any car due for service. Five seconds to know where things stand.

Pickup, as a guided flow

One screen at a time, in order, with no way to skip a step by accident:

- Check the license (already verified if the customer did it at home).
- Place the refundable deposit hold — one tap.
- Walk around the car: front, rear, left, right, interior. The camera stays open between shots; each photo is stamped with the time and place.
- Sign the agreement, or skip it because the customer already signed.
- Hand over the keys. The rental goes active and the customer gets a notification.

Return, as its mirror image

- Odometer and fuel, with sanity checks so one mistyped digit can't create a \$400 charge.
- The same five photos — then shown **side by side against the pickup photos**, angle by angle, so new damage is obvious instead of arguable.
- Extra charges calculated automatically from your own rules — mileage over the cap, missing fuel, late hours — itemized, and any line can be waived on the spot.
- Release the deposit, or keep part of it and open a damage claim with the photos attached.
- Receipt emailed. Done.

Built for the real world

The counter is often a garage with no signal. Everything above keeps working offline — photos and steps are saved on the phone and upload themselves when service returns.

If the phone dies or the app is closed mid-walkaround, reopening it puts staff back on the exact step they were on, with the photos they already took.

What you get

A web dashboard built for your laptop — admin-only, and deliberately more powerful than what staff or customers see. Everything the business knows, and the ability to change any of it.

The numbers

- Revenue this month, and the trend, with charts over 30 and 90 days.
- Utilization per car — which cars earn and which ones sit.
- What's on the road right now, and how much deposit money is being held.
- Direct bookings versus Turo, so you can see which channel carries the business.

The controls

Bookings	Every booking ever, searchable. Change dates, fix a status, create one by hand, cancel with a refund override when a situation deserves grace.
Fleet	Add and edit cars and photos, set rates and per-car rules, track maintenance, registration, and inspection dates.
Pricing	Weekend and seasonal rates, weekly and monthly discounts, extras and their prices.
Policies	Your business rules — mileage caps, late fees, refund tiers, deposits, minimum age. Change one and the next quote uses it. No developer needed.
Money	Every payment, hold, refund, and damage claim in one ledger, linked into Stripe.
Customers	Full history, license on file, notes.
Contracts	Edit the agreement template, and browse every signed contract.

Powerful, but never silent

Every change you make from the console is recorded — what changed, when, and from what to what. Deleting something needs a typed confirmation.

And a few things stay impossible even for you: you cannot double-book a car, and prices always come from the pricing rules. The console bends policy, never physics.

One calendar, three channels

Bookings arrive from three places. The whole design rests on them landing in one calendar that cannot contradict itself.

Your app	Books directly. Dates lock the instant payment succeeds.
Your website	Shows the same cars, availability, and prices, and books into the same calendar.
Turo	Turo has no public integration for this, so we use the emails Turo already sends you. You forward them automatically; the system reads each one and blocks those dates by itself.

What that gets you

- A car booked on Turo stops being bookable on your site and in your app within moments — without you touching anything.
- When an email doesn't parse cleanly, it goes into a short review list instead of being guessed at or dropped. Fixing one takes seconds.
- If a Turo trip ever arrives for dates you've already rented directly, that lands as an urgent alert — loudly, while there's still time to call someone — instead of quietly becoming two customers at one car.

The one manual step, and why

The reverse direction can't be automated: when a car is booked directly, its dates must be blocked on Turo by hand in Turo's own app. Anything else would mean automating against Turo in ways that risk your host account.

So the app makes it a tracked task — it appears on the booking, links straight into Turo, and stays until it's marked done.

What makes it trustworthy

"Bulletproof" was the requirement, so these are the specific promises the system is built to keep — each one designed for, and each one tested before launch.

No double bookings	Not a check that can be skipped — the database itself refuses to hold two overlapping bookings for one car. Two people tapping at the same instant: one wins, the other is offered the next open dates.
No lost work	Photos, signatures, and steps survive dead zones, dropped calls, and dead batteries. Nothing at the counter has to be done twice.
No arguments about damage	Every rental is bracketed by timestamped, location-stamped photos from both ends, matched angle to angle. Claims carry their evidence with them.
No disputed contracts	Signed agreements are sealed with a digital fingerprint and an audit trail — who signed, when, from where. They can never be quietly edited afterward.
No money drifting	Payments, holds, and refunds are reconciled against Stripe every day. Deposits that should have been released, or holds about to expire on a long rental, get caught and flagged instead of silently disappearing.
No silent failures	Anything the system can't handle confidently — an odd Turo email, a declined card, a conflict — becomes a visible task for a human, never a dropped event.
No surprises for renters	The same itemized numbers appear in the quote, the contract, and the receipt. Nothing appears on a bill that wasn't shown first.

Version one, and what waits

Everything described in this document is version one — it all ships before launch.

Deliberately left for later

Good ideas that would delay launch without changing whether the business runs well — written down, not forgotten:

- A countdown on the lock screen during an active rental.
 - Text-message reminders, if email and push notifications aren't enough.
 - A way for customers without the app to sign remotely from a web page.
 - Loyalty discounts and promo codes for repeat renters.
 - A card reader at the counter (version one takes counter payments by QR code).
 - Extra locations, more staff permission levels, and an Android app.
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What we need from you

The build can start without any of this — but these are the pieces only you can provide:

Your numbers	Mileage caps, late fee and grace period, fuel charge, refund tiers, weekend and seasonal pricing, weekly and monthly discounts, deposits per car, minimum renter age, and the turnaround time you need between rentals.
Your agreement	The paper contract you use today, so it becomes the template — and one attorney pass on the electronic version, including how you handle renter insurance.
Turo forwarding	An automatic forward rule for Turo's booking emails. One setting, once.
Website access	So bookings can go live on Bayrentals.com and links open in the app.

And then

A test day with real staff and a real car before a single customer touches it — cameras, offline behavior, the two-minute pickup, and whether someone who has never seen the app can run a rental with it. That day is the finish line, not the App Store submission.